

PALETTE · TWO FACES ON ONE CONTRACT

Carbone, in daylight

The graphite deck now has a light counterpart — the same identity, solved for paper.

The lime does not survive a light canvas, so it moves along one axis instead of changing hue.

- The measurement
 - #7DE38A reads 10.95:1 on graphite and **1.47:1** on paper.
- The move
 - The light arm is #037829 — the **same hue**, holding **95% of the chroma**, at L 0.50 instead of L 0.83. It reads 5.24:1.
- Why it matters
 - A darker *electric* green, not a desaturated forest one.

The bright value keeps the brand axis, the dark face, and the spectrum's dark arm.

The status washes are curated, not derived from the ink.

- ✓ Pass, warn and fail inks sit at OKLCH L 0.29–0.55 — AA on a self-tinted band and twelve frozen CVD ratchets pin them there
- ✓ Derived at 18%, a near-black ink over a light card measured chroma 0.0178 — very nearly achromatic
- ✓ Curating the source lifts it to 0.0661, and the ink-on-band contrast improves from 5.78 to 7.04
- Warn sits at the 3:1 graphical floor rather than AA; its pills were already sanctioned on both faces
- The tightest clearing CVD margin is +0.0126, at pass^warn under achromatopsia

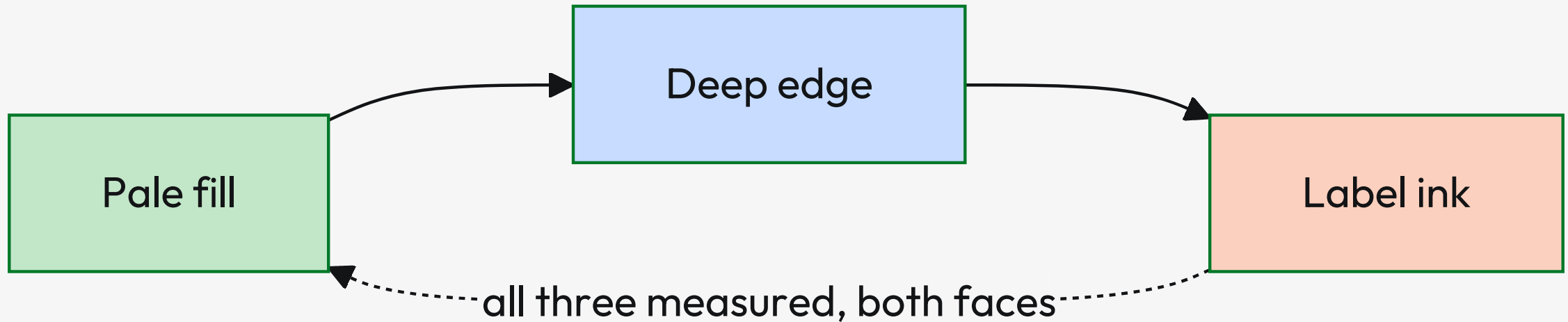
The code block stays graphite on both faces, and that is the most recognizable thing carbone owns.

--surface-inverse is dark in light mode too

```
/* One token decides it, and it is deliberately NOT an inverse of the canvas. */
--surface-inverse: light-dark(#0E0E10, #0E0E10);

/* So the twelve --hljs-* values curated for a near-black ground stay valid,
   unchanged, on a deck whose canvas is now off-white. */
--hljs-keyword: #7DE38A; /* the electric lime, still doing its original job */
--hljs-string: #88D4A8;
```

Twelve slots, each a flipping pair of one hue, solved rather than picked.



Light arms hold each dark mark's hue and solve only lightness: mark-vs-canvas ≥ 3 , ink-on-fill ≥ 4.5 , on-mark ≥ 4.5 , and fill $\neq$ mark.

THE MISTAKE WORTH RECORDING

Neutral paper was never the problem; light gray ink was.

- Wrong turn one
 - Inverting the dark ramp gave mid-gray ink on gray paper. It read washed out.
- Wrong turn two
 - Tinting everything cool slate (h=252) cured the wash — and made carbone indaco's hue, with a green accent.
- What carbone's became
 - Graphite: paper C 0.0013, near-black ink at 17.07:1 heading and 12.29:1 body. The lime is the only color.

A green ground was tried first and rejected — it swallowed the semantic pass state.

ONE LINE WORTH KEEPING

A palette's monochrome must differ in hue from its semantics, or the signal stops reading as a signal.

- The failed candidate
 - At h=165 the paper tied beautifully to the lime — and the canvas, the neutral rows and the pass rows were all green together.
- Why the references hold
 - Indaco is navy and cuoio is warm brown, and both keep a green pass. That is not a coincidence; it is the constraint.
- The cost of getting it wrong
 - Nothing fails a gate. Every contrast number still clears. The deck simply stops communicating state.

THE DARK SURFACES AND INK ARE THE ONES CARBONE ALWAYS SHIPPED. A DECK THAT MEANS THE GRAPHITE
CANVAS ASKS FOR IT BY NAME.

WHAT THIS FACE IS FOR

theme: carbone is the light
one now; carbone-dark is
the deck you already had.